

JOSEPH POINTER

AI Adoption and Transformation Leader | Operating Model, Governance, and Capability Building

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PROFILE

Most AI investments fail at adoption rather than at technology. I spent fifteen years at TIAA (\$1.5T AUM, Fortune 100), where Risk, Compliance, and Legal could stop anything I built, which is why I know when to bring governance in, after an idea has shape and before anything launches. I conceived an AI-powered career development platform there in late 2024 and owned it end to end. The platform itself went company-wide. AI adoption inside Client Services ran through an operating model I built across seven business areas whose leaders did not report to me, the same structure I had already been running workplace change, recognition, and engagement through. Before TIAA I spent ten years owning enterprise platform programs for Fortune 500 clients as a project and product manager, architecting the knowledge model behind a single-source publishing platform and facilitating working sessions internationally. I am not a software engineer. I have built enough to know what I am asking for when I ask an engineer for it.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director, Business Management

February 2022 - July 2026

TIAA, Denver, CO. Fortune 100 financial services, \$1.5T AUM, fiduciary duty under ERISA and SEC oversight.

With TIAA since May 2011. Business Manager (2016-2022) | Senior Business Management Specialist, internal Lean Consultant (2013-2016) | Business Consultant (2011-2013)

AI From Concept to Company-Wide Adoption

- **Took an AI platform from an idea to a company-wide launch.** Beginning in late 2024 I conceived a 9-module AI-powered career development platform and led the team that built it, first for a major transformation population and then across the company. I owned use-case scoping and prioritization, phased rollout, governance, adoption strategy, and impact measurement. 16,000+ associates had access to it and I reached 1,500+ directly across 30+ town halls, team sessions, and one-on-one coaching, because you cannot send an email and call it adoption.
- **Defined the measures and carried them to the executives.** I defined the success measures, instrumented them, and reported them to senior leaders through executive read-outs, business cases, and quarterly business reviews. Adoption was measured by active usage, never by headcount with access.
- **Built the manager guide myself, in a week.** I built the platform's manager guide with Amazon Q Developer in a week, so the people asked to lead the change had something usable in front of them.

The Operating Model AI Adoption Ran Through

- **Built the structure once and ran four programs through it.** I connected seven Client Services business areas through named liaisons, shared strategy, and peer learning, and ran workplace change, recognition, engagement, and AI adoption through the same structure rather than rebuilding it each time. Enablement, standards, and measurement ran from one place while every area kept ownership of its own work. I set the operating rhythm and the prioritization, and none of the seven leaders reported to me.

Governance and Risk Partnership

- **Prototyped first, then set the hard limits.** I explored and prototyped first, then brought Risk, Compliance, and Legal in to set the limits once an idea was worth building. No client data or PII was allowed to be entered into the platform. No AI-initiated actions. Guided prompts that keep the person in control of every decision.
- **Owned the permission surface an assistant would inherit.** I owned SharePoint governance across a 125-site estate and remediated 1,763 files flagged for PII with IT. An assistant surfaces to a person everything they already have permission to reach. That is the same exposure I remediated, before an assistant was the reason to care about it.

- **Graded vendors when the money was real.** I held a seat on the corporate team that selected an enterprise platform, helping write the RFP and grading every proposal and finalist presentation. That was not an AI purchase and I do not present it as one. The build-versus-buy evaluation discipline transfers.

Workforce Capability and Change People Did Not Choose

- **Built the capability program for a transformation population.** I led a team of seven to build Skills of the Future, five curriculum tracks of 12 to 17 modules each for the associates affected by the Recordkeeping Transformation, reaching 890 users. It was asynchronous and self-paced by design.
- **700 people absorbed a smaller building without a retention crisis.** Corporate Real Estate set the target and I directed the execution of the Denver consolidation, moving 700 associates from assigned seating into a hoteling model and giving back five floors, roughly 44 percent of the square footage, while the work kept running. The number was the plan. Getting people to live inside it afterward was the job, and I was recognized as Change Champion for it. I also managed the Frisco Corporate Center transition for 500+ associates.
- **Built the budget and defended what it bought.** I built and negotiated a \$300K annual Client Services engagement budget with Finance, inside roughly \$500K of Client Services program spend I administered.

Senior Sales Engineer, Product Manager, Project Manager, Information Architect

**January 2001 -
March 2011**

Interactive Media / FT Knowledge / Pearson Performance Solutions / Vangent Human Capital, Denver, CO.

- **Owned enterprise platform programs for Fortune 500 clients.** Continuous tenure through a chain of acquisitions, advancing into project and product management. I architected the knowledge model behind an enterprise LCMS and single-source publishing platform, then carried it as program and product owner across deployments at five Fortune 500 clients, scoping and shaping multi-year implementation plans for Unilever, Bank of America, GE Capital, and Verizon Wireless. I facilitated working sessions internationally and traveled for them often.

INDEPENDENT AI WORK, 2024 TO PRESENT

- **A standing team of AI agents I operate daily.** Each agent has a defined role and a named gate, including an adversarial reviewer whose job is to attack the output before it ships. Before changing which model each agent runs on I wrote down what degradation would look like and set a revert-first rule, so the failure criteria existed before the change did. I published the methodology behind this practice in 2026.
- **Two live products, built on my own time.** CareerPointers (careerpointers.org), where I conceived the journey, a four-agent AI interview simulator, and an applicant CRM, and directed the build. Future Me, Answered (futuremeanswered.com), where I designed the 5-stage framework, structured career data across 922 occupations, and developed most of the application by directing AI. Mike Pointer is co-founder and engineered the production backend, the databases and security that made them real.

LEADERSHIP CAPABILITIES

AI Transformation and Operating Model: Adoption Operating Model Design | Use-Case Scoping, Assessment and Prioritization | Pilot-to-Production Scaling | Adoption KPIs and Measurement | Champion Networks and Peer Learning | AI Literacy and Capability Building | Business Process Redesign | Agentic and Multi-Agent LLM Workflows | Hands-on across Claude, Microsoft 365 Copilot, ChatGPT, Amazon Q Developer, Kiro

Governance and Risk Partnership: Responsible AI Governance and Acceptable-Use Standards | Risk, Compliance and Legal Partnership | Permission and Access Exposure Review | Data Privacy Remediation | Build-versus-Buy Evaluation and RFP Scoring | Organizational Change Management

Enterprise and Executive: Executive Read-Outs, Business Cases and Quarterly Business Reviews | Client Services Budget Ownership and Negotiation | Cross-Functional Leadership Without Line Authority | Regulated Industry Delivery (ERISA, SEC) | Enterprise Platform Programs (LCMS, ATS) | Microsoft 365 and SharePoint Governance

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

M.S. Instructional Technology, Bloomsburg University, PA (4.0 GPA) | B.A. Art, Millersville University, PA
Generative AI Leader Certification, Google (2026) | Lean for Financial Services, TIAA (inaugural class) | Leadership Skills, The Institute for Management Studies (2025)